

ART & CULTURE



INDIAN ARCHITECTURE

MODULE - 24

**ARCHITECTURE OF
COLONIAL TIMES**

EVOLUTION OF MODERN ARCHITECTURE IN INDIA



- 1 The period of Indian history of late 18th Century onwards, saw a steady decline in the power of the Mughal Dynasty and other Indian rulers.
- 2 In different parts of the country, European colonial powers established their political authority.
- 3 As a result it brought an end to the Islamic rule and with it, the Indo-Islamic Architecture. It also marked the beginning of what is referred to as **the Colonial Architecture**.

EVOLUTION OF MODERN ARCHITECTURE IN INDIA



VICTORIAN STYLE OF BRITISH

- 4 Although the British Authority vested control over the largest part of Indian territory, the Portuguese, French, and Dutch too had smaller regions of stronghold.
- 5 Thus, the period of the last 250-300 years saw varied influences on the Indian architecture in different parts of the country.
- 6 This could be the **Neo-Classical**, the **Romanesque**, the **Victorian or Gothic** influence as in British structures, the **Iberian** and the **Baroque** influences in the Portuguese structures (of Goa) or the **Cartesian Grid plan** architectural influences of the **French** (Pondicherry, now Puducherry).

EVOLUTION OF MODERN ARCHITECTURE IN INDIA



**BAROQUE STYLE OF
PORTUGUESE**



**CARTESIAN GRID PLAN ARCHITECTURE OF
PUDUCHERRY**

EVOLUTION OF MODERN ARCHITECTURE IN INDIA



**CHANDIGARH AS DESIGNED BY
LE CORBUSIER**

- 7 Post-Independence Indian architecture initially suffered from a hangover of the colonial era.
- 8 Later, it was inspired by the various architecture movements in Europe and America.
- 9 However, growth of modern cities like Chandigarh gave opportunity for development of modern architectural style based on the indigenous need and ethics. They were example of modern architecture which is still evolving.
- 10 In the present context, utility, cost, energy consumption and green architecture of modern structures have been important considerations influencing the architecture apart from the aesthetic of structures.

COLONIAL ARCHITECTURE

A brief account of different architectural style, poignant features and important buildings in the colonial period are discussed here.

REGION: PUDUCHERRY

FRENCH ARCHITECTURE IN INDIA



**CHURCH OF SACRED HEART
OF JESUS**

- 1** The city layout was characterized by Cartesian grid plan and urban design of settlements.
- 2** Structures had Classical architectural plan
- 3** Prominent examples include, the Church of Sacred Heart of Jesus, Eglise de Notre Dame de Anges and Eglise de Notre Dame de Lourdes.

COLONIAL ARCHITECTURE

PORTUGUESE ARCHITECTURE IN INDIA

REGION: GOA AND KOCHI

- 1 The Portuguese arrived in India as merchants in 1498 and remained till the next 400 years in Goa.



BASILICA OF BOM JESUS

- 2 Portuguese architecture is seen in Churches and houses of Goa. The Churches typically depicted the **Baroque Architecture Style** (Renaissance Architecture of Europe).
- 3 **Basilica of Bom Jesus (UNESCO WHS)** built in 1606 which holds mortal remains of **St. Francis Xavier** is the best example of this style
- 4 Other prominent structure **Church of St. Francis of Assi, Our Lady of Immaculate Conception, Reis Magos Fort** in Goa and **St. Francis church** of Kochi.

COLONIAL ARCHITECTURE

PORTUGUESE ARCHITECTURE IN INDIA

REGION: GOA AND KOCHI



**OUR LADY OF IMMACULATE
CONCEPTION CHURCH, GOA**



St. FRANCIS CHURCH OF KOCHI

COLONIAL ARCHITECTURE

DUTCH ARCHITECTURE IN INDIA

REGION: SURAT,
AHMEDABAD AND KOCHI

- 1 The Dutch started trading in India in the early 17th Century and remained in India for nearly 200 years.



CEMETRY IN AHMEDABAD

- 2 They colonized areas in Ahmedabad, Surat, Bharuch and Kochi which they took over from the Portuguese.
- 3 The Dutch Architecture is visible in a variety of surviving structures which include Dutch Factory (built in 1630 in Bharuch), cemetery in Ahmedabad, Mattancherry Palace in Kochi (originally built by Portuguese), David Hall (former residence of Dutch commanders in Kochi).

COLONIAL ARCHITECTURE

REGION: SURAT,
AHMEDABAD AND KOCHI

DUTCH ARCHITECTURE IN INDIA



MATTANCHERRY PALACE, KOCHI

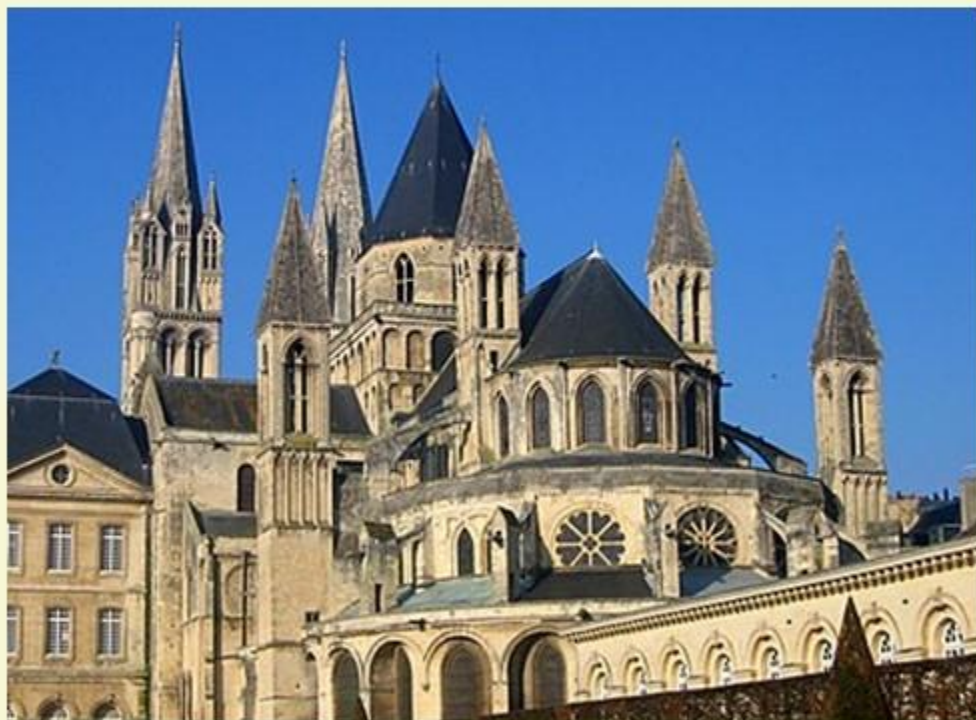


DAVID HALL IN KOCHI

COLONIAL ARCHITECTURE

BRITISH ARCHITECTURE IN INDIA

REGION: KOLKATA,
NEW DELHI, CHENNAI



GOTHIC STYLE OF ARCHITECTURE

- 1 The British Regime extended to large parts of India and influenced the Indian architecture the most.
- 2 British Architecture brought with itself different Architectural styles referred to as the Gothic, Imperial, Victorian, Renaissance etc. which also incorporated the indigenous architectural features or some elements of it.

COLONIAL ARCHITECTURE

BRITISH ARCHITECTURE IN INDIA

REGION: KOLKATA,
NEW DELHI, CHENNAI



VICTORIAN STYLE

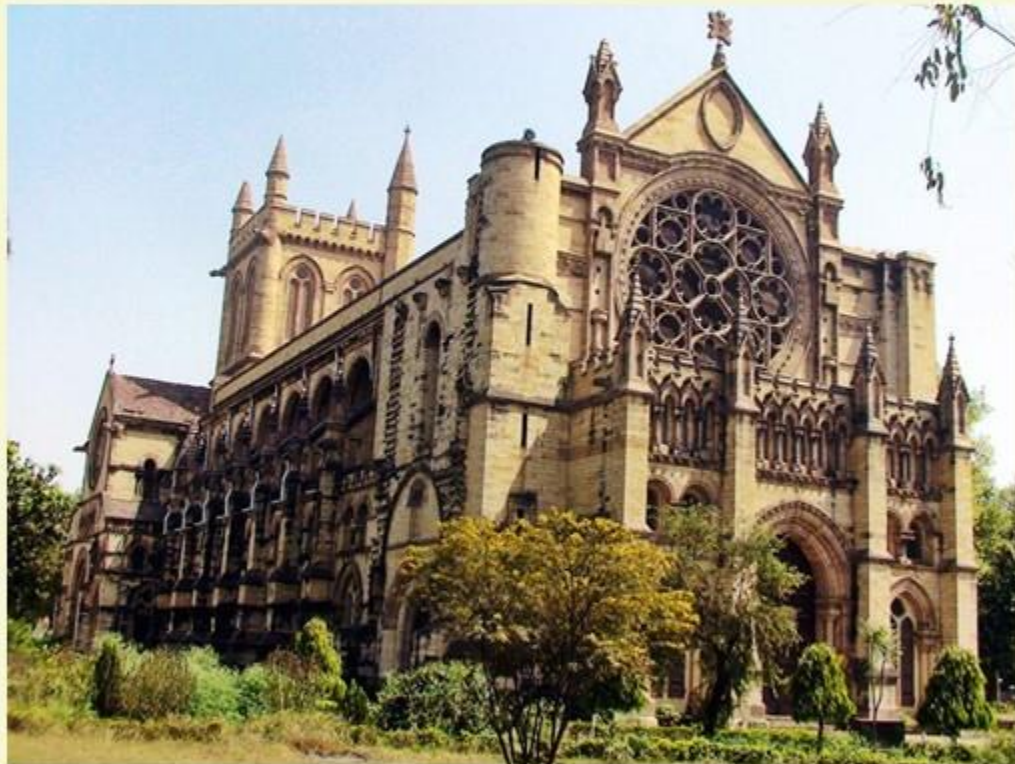
3 The style and architecture are reflected in a variety of structures ranging from forts, palatial structures, residences, official buildings, churches, commemorative structures, to ordinary residences, dak-bungalows, etc.

4 Victorian style which is also referred as the **Indo-Gothic style** and **Indo-Saracenic style** incorporated elements of Gothic, Persian and the indigenous Indian style.

COLONIAL ARCHITECTURE

BRITISH ARCHITECTURE IN INDIA

REGION: KOLKATA,
NEW DELHI, CHENNAI



ALL SAINTS CATHEDRAL

- 5** It included features like **pointed arches**, **large windows**, **thinner walls** (than Islamic style), domed roofs, etc. in rather large sized structures.
- 6** It incorporated use of modern construction techniques such as **iron and steel**, **bricks** along with stones and later concrete.
- 7** Prominent examples include the **Victoria Memorial**, **Fort William** and Raj Bhavan in Kolkata, **Victoria Terminus** and **Gateway of India** in Mumbai, Secretariat complex in Delhi, All Saints Cathedral in Allahabad and St. Michael's Cathedral in Shimla.

COLONIAL ARCHITECTURE

BRITISH ARCHITECTURE IN INDIA

REGION: KOLKATA,
NEW DELHI, CHENNAI

KOLKATTA



VICTORIA MEMORIAL



RAJ BHAVAN

COLONIAL ARCHITECTURE

BRITISH ARCHITECTURE IN INDIA

REGION: KOLKATA,
NEW DELHI, CHENNAI

MUMBAI



VICTORIA TERMINUS



GATEWAY OF INDIA

COLONIAL ARCHITECTURE

BRITISH ARCHITECTURE IN INDIA

REGION: KOLKATA,
NEW DELHI, CHENNAI



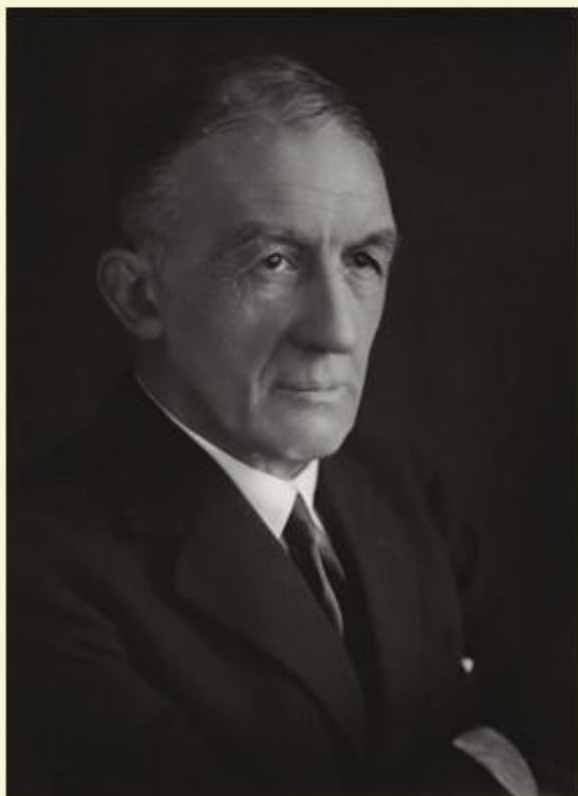
EDWIN LUTYENS

- 8 New Delhi and the neo-Roman architecture: In 1911, the capital of British India shifted from Kolkata to New Delhi where the construction of the city of New Delhi was done.
- 9 Designed primarily by *architect Edwin Lutyens* who was responsible for the overall layout and also for the architecture of the Viceroy's house, India Gate etc. The new city was said to have Neo-Roman or Neo-Classical architecture.

COLONIAL ARCHITECTURE

BRITISH ARCHITECTURE IN INDIA

REGION: KOLKATA,
NEW DELHI, CHENNAI



HERBERT BAKER

10 The structures employed elements of Roman architecture, viz. columns, arches and domes but also added a number of indigenous elements such as **Chattris, Jaalis etc.**

11 Another prominent architect, **Herbert Baker** designed the North and South Blocks adjoining the Viceroy's House (now Rashtrapati Bhavan), the Parliament House etc, while **Robert Tor Russell** built the Connaught Place and the Eastern and Western Courts.

COLONIAL ARCHITECTURE

REGION: KOLKATA,
NEW DELHI, CHENNAI

BRITISH ARCHITECTURE
IN INDIA



NORTH BLOCK AND SOUTH BLOCK BY HERBERT BAKER

COLONIAL ARCHITECTURE

BRITISH ARCHITECTURE IN INDIA

REGION: KOLKATA,
NEW DELHI, CHENNAI



CONNAUGHT PLACE BY ROBERT
TOR RUSSELL



AN AERIAL VIEW OF CONNAUGHT PLACE

EVOLUTION OF MODERN ARCHITECTURE IN INDIA



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LE CORBUSIER**

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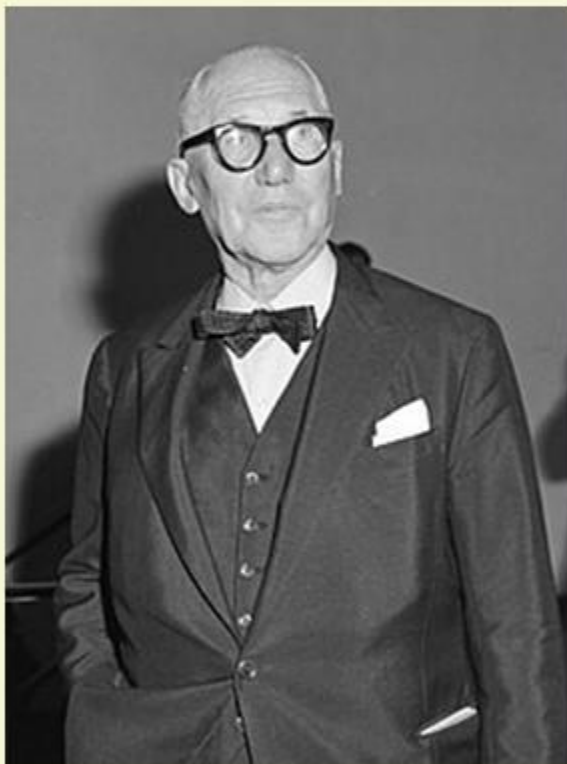
POST INDEPENDENCE ARCHITECTURE



- 1 For years to come post-independence, the Indian Architecture did not evolve much.
- 2 Rather, it was caught between two architectural schools of thought, the Revivalists and the Modernists.
- 3 While the Revivalists believed in continuing the past architectural tradition, the Modernists wanted to emulate the modern European and American architectural movement.

POST INDEPENDENCE ARCHITECTURE

ARCHITECTURE OF CHANDIGARH



LE CORBUSIER

- 1 An important leap in Indian architecture took place in the **design of the capital city of Punjab (Chandigarh)** by Le Corbusier (a Swiss French Architect).
- 2 Pierre Jeanneret, Jane Drew and Maxwell Fry were other associate architects.
- 3 The city of Chandigarh was divided into three sections (metaphorically).
- 4 The **topmost or head** contained the capital complex comprising the **Political, Judicial and Administrative** buildings.

POST INDEPENDENCE ARCHITECTURE

ARCHITECTURE OF CHANDIGARH

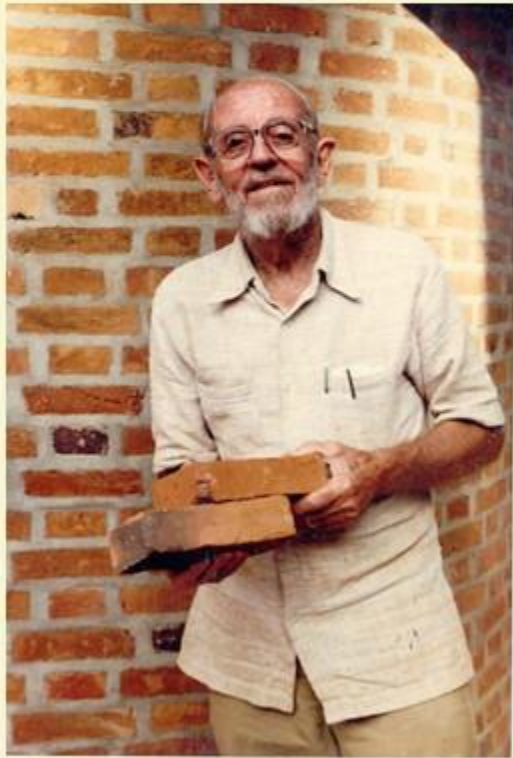


**LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY COMPLEX
OF CHANDIGARH**

- 5** The middle portion or the body housed the residential, educational and commercial complexes with the commercial complex being at the metaphorical heart and arms which were perpendicular to the main axis had academic and leisure facilities.
- 6** The lower portion or feet consisted of the industrial complex and the railway station.

POST INDEPENDENCE ARCHITECTURE

ARCHITECTURE OF CHANDIGARH



LAURIE BAKER



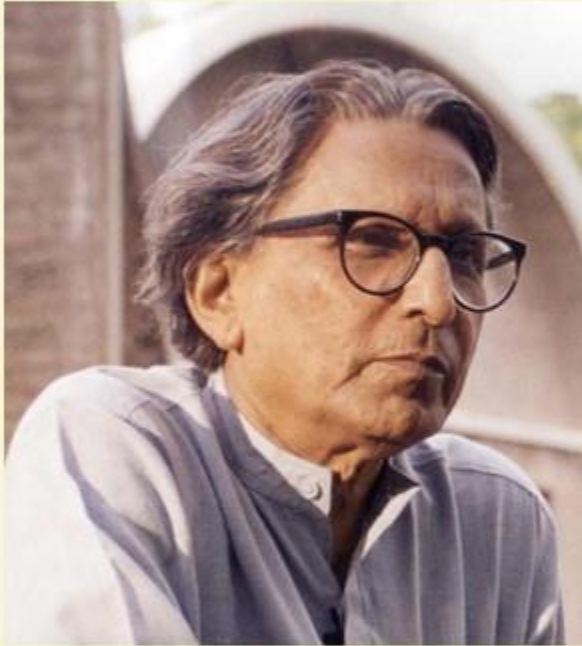
**LAURIE BAKER'S UNIQUE
MASTERPIECES**

7 In 2016, the capital complex of Chandigarh was declared as the UNESCO World Heritage Site under the inscription of architectural work of Le Corbusier, an outstanding contribution to the modern movement.

8 Other important architectural efforts have been that of Laurie Baker who significantly contributed to the mass housing concept in Kerala and the design of Charles Mark Correa and B.V. Doshi.

POST INDEPENDENCE ARCHITECTURE

OTHER IMPORTANT ARCHITECTS



BALAKRISHNA DOSHI

In 2018, BV Doshi received the highest and the most illustrious award of Architecture. Guess which one are we talking about here?



**ARANYA LOW
COST HOUSING**



IIM- BANGALORE

POST INDEPENDENCE ARCHITECTURE

OTHER IMPORTANT ARCHITECTS



CHARLES CORREA



**MAHATMA GANDHI SANGRAHALAYA,
AHMEDABAD**

WE EXPRESS OUR SINCERE THANKS FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

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